



A brief pause from duty: NSG commandos share a moment with Rajasthan Royals head coach Kumar Sangakkara after the match in Mumbai. SHAYAN ACHARYA

The last photograph, the first deadline

As IPL 2026 draws to a close, *Sportstar's* reporters bring you the **off-field moments**, quirky encounters and behind-the-scenes stories that never make the scorecard.

Rajasthan Royals' IPL campaign may have ended on a disappointing note, but its final league fixture against Mumbai Indians at the Wankhede Stadium produced a memorable moment away from the action.

After the last league fixture, Rajasthan Royals head coach Kumar Sangakkara spent a few minutes interacting with the National Security Guard (NSG) commandos deployed at the venue. As the crowd began to disperse and the post-match bustle

settled, the former Sri Lanka captain stopped to greet the personnel tasked with securing one of the IPL's most high-profile fixtures.

The commandos, who had spent the evening on duty, gathered around Sangakkara for a photograph. For a brief moment, the security cordon gave way to smiles as the decorated batter posed with the men in black.

Sangakkara, known for his approachable nature, patiently exchanged pleasantries and posed for pictures, much to the delight of the commandos, many of whom are

keen followers of the sport.

The scene offered a glimpse into a side of the IPL rarely seen by fans. While players, coaches and support staff occupy centre stage, hundreds of security personnel work behind the scenes to ensure the tournament runs smoothly.

For the NSG commandos, it was a rare opportunity to meet one of cricket's most admired figures up close. For Sangakkara, it was a simple gesture of appreciation towards a group whose work often goes unnoticed.

Shayan Acharya